

Editing Workflow *Guide*

How to make changes to the website using the design space and Cowork — and how to do it without ever losing your work or breaking the live site.

1 The big picture: three places

Your website really lives in **three places**, and changes flow between them. Once you know what each one is for, the rest is easy.

PLAN

Design Space

Mark up changes visually. Preview. Generate a prompt.

PROMPT ↓

BUILD

Cowork

Makes the edits and publishes them.

PUBLISH ↓

RECORD

GitHub

The official copy. Powers the live preview link.

The design space can also pull a fresh copy from GitHub — but it can't push back. Only Cowork publishes.

2 What each one is good at

Design Space (here)

- Mark up text visually — click and comment
- Make many edits in one pass
- Live preview before anything ships
- Cannot publish to the live site

Cowork

- Makes edits from written instructions
- Publishes changes to GitHub for you
- Your main build + deploy workspace
- No visual click-to-mark-up

GitHub

- The official record of the site
- Powers your live preview link
- The “source of truth” everything syncs to
- Not where you edit directly

3 The one golden rule

NEVER EDIT IN TWO PLACES AT ONCE

Only **one** tool should be editing the files between syncs. Always start a new round of edits from the **freshes**t version. As long as you don’t have the design space and Cowork both changing files at the same time, you will never hit a merge conflict.

4 Recommended flow for a batch of edits

Use the design space to **plan**, and Cowork to **do + publish**. Best of both worlds, no files to shuffle back and forth.

1

Import the current site into the design space

So what you mark up matches your real, latest site — not an old copy. (Ask: “import my repo so I can mark it up.”)

2

Mark up everything visually, all at once

Comments, text edits, “make this two lines,” move things around — this is what the design space is best at.

3

Turn the markups into one clean prompt

Ask: “put all my changes into a prompt I can paste into Cowork.” You get a tidy, numbered list grouped by page.

4

Paste that prompt into Cowork

Cowork makes the edits and publishes them. Everything stays in one place — nothing diverges.

5 If you'd rather edit straight in Cowork

Cowork can't do visual mark-up, so help it by being specific:

- Group your edits by page ("On about.html...", "On news.html...").
- Phrase each as find → change: "Find 'X' and change it to 'Y.'"
- Quote the existing wording exactly — the more precisely you quote what's there now, the more reliably it finds and changes the right thing.
- Send them together in one message rather than one at a time.

6 What "importing" actually does

Think of the design space as a **scratchpad**, and importing as **photocopying** your real site onto it.

Importing is always safe because...

- ✓ It only copies files into the design space — it never touches GitHub or Cowork.
- ✓ Your live site is completely unaffected, no matter what happens on the scratchpad.
- ✓ It replaces same-named files *in the scratchpad only* — backup folders (different names) are left alone.
- ✓ Nothing in the design space is precious: the real versions are on GitHub and in your backup folders.

7 Your safety nets

- ✓ GitHub keeps every past version — you can always roll back to an earlier one.
- ✓ Backup folders (e.g. `_backup-YYYY-MM-DD`) hold untouched "before" copies. Just ask to "restore [file] from the backup."
- ✓ Keep your own folder copy on your computer before a big batch — belt and suspenders.
- ✓ When in doubt, ask first. Nothing goes live until Cowork publishes it.

8 Plain-English glossary

Repo

Short for "repository" — the folder of all your website files stored on GitHub.

Import / Pull

Copy the latest files *from* GitHub *into* the design space to work on.

Publish / Push

Send finished changes *up* to GitHub so they go live. (Cowork does this.)

Source of truth

The one official copy everything syncs to — your GitHub repo.

Prompt

The written list of changes you paste into Cowork for it to carry out.

Merge conflict

What happens when two places edit the same file at once. Avoided by the golden rule (§3).